

Word 30: REMUNERATION (ri-MYOO-nuh-RAY-shin)

Payment, compensation, or reward.

Remuneration is a suitable payment or reward for a service or something one has provided: “It is rare that the effort a writer expends in writing a book is commensurate with the remuneration received for writing it”; “When people volunteer their services for a cause, the satisfaction they get from doing something they believe in is more than enough remuneration”; “Mark took the job even though he knew the salary was not sufficient remuneration for the work he would have to do.”

Synonyms of *remuneration* include *reimbursement*, *recompense* (REK-um-PENTS), *consideration*, *indemnification* (in-DEM-nuh-fi-KAY-shin), and *emolument* (i-MAHL-yuh-mint, word 3 of Level 8).

The corresponding verb is *remunerate* (ri-MYOO-nuh-rayt), to pay or compensate for services rendered, trouble taken, or goods provided.



Let’s review the ten keywords you’ve just learned. I’ll give you two words, and you decide if they are synonyms or antonyms. Answers appear on [this page](#).

1. *Proportionate* and *commensurate* are...synonyms or antonyms?
2. *Incessant* and *intermittent* are...
3. *Sycophant* and *toady* are...
4. *Tangential* and *unrelated* are...
5. *Indefensible* and *tenable* are...
6. *Tangible* and *impalpable* are...
7. *Odious* and *detestable* are...
8. *Ubiquitous* and *nonexistent* are...

9. To *ruminate* and to *meditate* are...
10. *Compensation* and *remuneration* are...

If you answered fewer than eight of the questions correctly in this quiz, remember to review the keyword discussions before moving ahead in the program.



Now let's return to the *Verbal Advantage* vocabulary for the next ten keywords in Level 6.

Word 31: PECCADILLO (PEK-uh-DIL-oh)

A small sin, slight offense, minor fault or flaw.

Peccadillo means literally “a small sin.” It comes through Spanish and Italian ultimately from the Latin *peccare*, to make a mistake, blunder, sin. From the same source English has also inherited three other useful words: *peccant* (PEK-int), which means guilty, sinful, culpable; *peccable* (PEK-uh-buul), which means liable to sin or do wrong; and its antonym *impeccable* (word 40 of Level 4), which means incapable of sin, unable to do wrong, and therefore free from all faults or imperfections.

Synonyms of *peccadillo* include *failing*, *frailty*, and *foible* (word 23 of Level 3). All these words suggest a weakness, imperfection, or defect of character or habit. *Failing* implies a relatively minor but noticeable shortcoming: Parents are never perfect; all have their failings. *Frailty* implies a weakness that can be exploited or that leads one to yield to temptation: Frailties are an inescapable part of human nature. *Foible* suggests a harmless or trivial weakness or flaw that can be easily overlooked: You may regret your failings and try to keep your frailties in check, but you can laugh about your foibles. Our keyword, *peccadillo*, is a small sin or slight offense that is easily forgiven: A good manager knows how to distinguish between an employee who commits peccadilloes and an employee who causes problems.

The plural of *peccadillo* is *peccadilloes*, which is preferred by most American authorities and listed first in American dictionaries, or *peccadillos*, the British preference.

Word 32: SUPINE (soo-PYN, like *sue pine*)

Lying down on the back, with the face turned upward: “He preferred to sleep in a supine position.”

Supine, *prone*, *prostrate* (PRAHS-trayt), and *recumbent* (ri-KUHM-bent) all mean lying down in various ways.

Supine takes its meaning directly from the Latin *supinus*, lying on the back with the face up.

From the Latin *pronus*, leaning forward, we inherit the word *prone*, which may mean inclined or tending toward something, as in the phrase “prone to error,” or it may mean lying on the belly, stretched out face downward: “The dog lay prone on the rug, its chin resting on its paws.”

Prostrate means lying flat, stretched out, either prone or supine. Because the word comes from the Latin *prosternere*, to throw down in front, cast down, in modern usage *prostrate* denotes lying down flat either as the result of physical or emotional exhaustion, or as an expression of submission, humble adoration, humiliation, or helplessness.

Be careful not to confuse *prostrate* with *prostate* (PRAHS-tayt), the gland in men that contributes to the production of semen and helps control urination. After age forty, men should have regular checkups for prostate cancer, not prostrate cancer.

Recumbent comes from the Latin *recumbere*, to lie back, recline. When you are recumbent you are lying down in a comfortable position, usually supine or on your side: The ancient Greeks and Romans assumed a recumbent posture when taking their meals. Visit any art museum and you are likely to see a portrait of a recumbent nude.